

» SULFIDES

**ORPIMENT**

Monoclinic

H 1½–2 • SG 3.49

Named from the Latin for “golden paint”, this arsenic sulfide occurs as foliated, columnar masses around hot springs.

**REALGAR**

Monoclinic • H 1½–2 • SG 3.56

A bright orange-red sulfide of arsenic, realgar was historically used as a pigment.

**GLAUCODOT**

Orthorhombic • H 5 • SG 6.05

This sulfide of cobalt, iron, and arsenic occurs as silver-white pyramidal crystals and brittle masses.

MOLYBDENITE

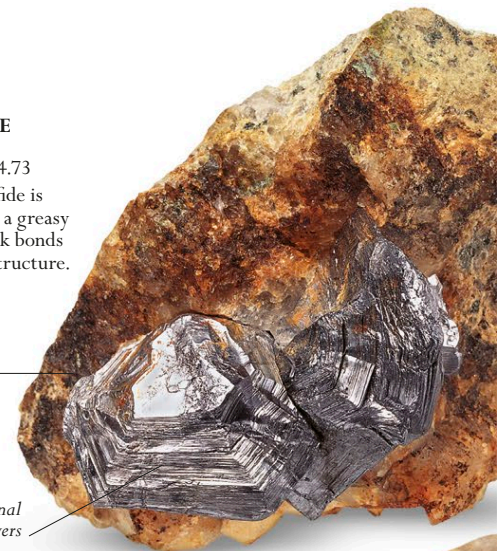
Hexagonal

H 1½ • SG 4.62–4.73

This molybdenum sulfide is lead-grey in colour. It has a greasy feel, which is due to weak bonds within a layered atomic structure.

granite

thin hexagonal crystals in layers

**MARCASITE**

Orthorhombic

H 6–6½ • SG 4.89

A sulfide of iron that is lighter and more brittle than pyrite, marcasite frequently occurs as cockscombs and spear-shaped “twins”.



indigo-blue covellite

COVELLITE

Hexagonal • H 1½–2 • SG 4.68

Although covellite is rare, it is a widespread copper sulfide. Its shining indigo-blue colour makes it attractive to mineral collectors.



slender prismatic crystals

HAUERITE

Cubic • H 4 • SG 3.46

Hauerite is a very rare sulfide of manganese. The brown octahedral crystals can form when certain minerals are altered in the caps of salt domes.

ARSENOPYRITE

Monoclinic

H 5½–6 • SG 6.07

Silvery-coloured arsenopyrite is a sulfide of arsenic and iron. With almost 50 per cent arsenic content, it is a principal ore of arsenic which is poisonous to humans.

**STANNITE**

Tetragonal • H 4 • SG 4.3–4.5

Stannite is a sulfide of tin, copper, and iron mined for the tin. Its name comes from the Latin for tin, *stannum*.

**PENTLANDITE**

Cubic

H 3½–4 • SG 4.6–5

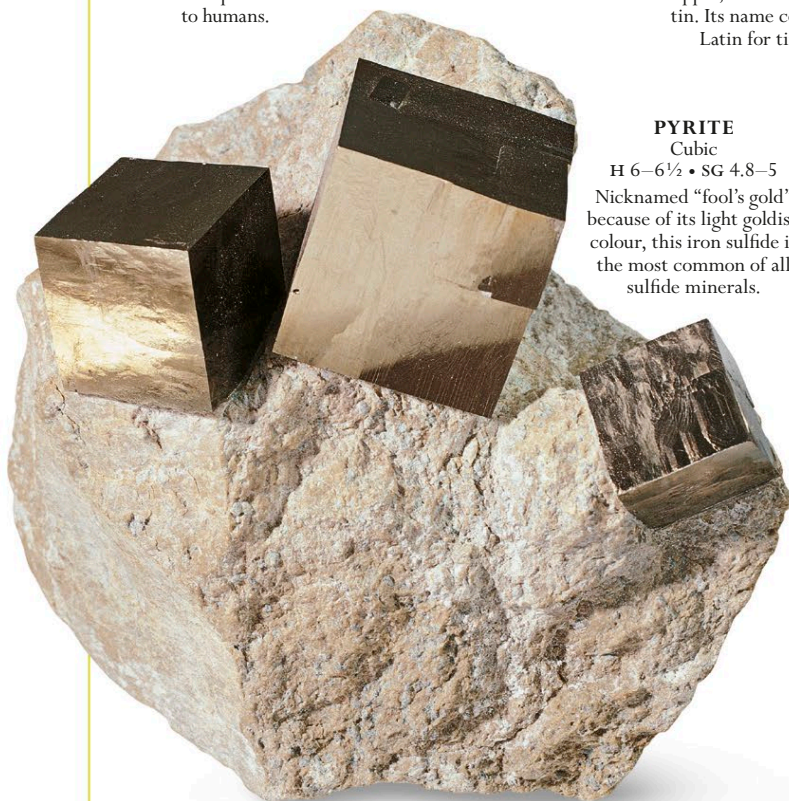
This nickel and iron sulfide is found in basic igneous rocks. It is an important source of nickel.

PYRITE

Cubic

H 6–6½ • SG 4.8–5

Nicknamed “fool’s gold” because of its light goldish colour, this iron sulfide is the most common of all sulfide minerals.

**PYRRHOTITE**

Monoclinic • H 3½–4½ • SG 4.58–4.65

An iron sulfide with variable iron content, pyrrhotite has a magnetism that increases as the iron content decreases.

**CHALCOCITE**

Monoclinic • H 2½–3 • SG 5.5–5.8

Dark grey to black in colour, this copper sulfide has been mined for centuries. It is one of the most profitable copper ores.

calcite groundmass

